



“(We are) blending consumer insights with innovation to ensure products are functional, stylish and aligned with Gen Z’s aspiration for convenience”

ASHISH GOUPAL
CEO (INDIA CORE BUSINESS), MARICO

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“A 30-second ad must be complemented by storytelling. Digital is a big part of the piece, and one must look at the time spent by Gen Z on social media”

NITIN SAINI
CMO, MONDELEZ

stylish and aligned with Gen Z’s aspirations for self-expression and convenience,” says Goupal.

The part on brand loyalty starts to get a little intricate here. Jaiswal thinks the route to get there will change, and the language is about consumer engagement. “We are really speaking of sharing videos, them going viral or reviews. In this ecosystem, consumer loyalty is challenging to build and sustain,” he says.

If language is critical, no less important is lingo. Pidilite employed AI for its Fevikwik campaign. Using KwikGPT, it fuses random objects that consumers choose to make them quirky innovations. “It is important to learn the Gen Z lingo,” says Tanwani. That led to terms such as dumbbell heel and time waist. For a long time, Pidilite has come to be known for quirky advertising. “Humour makes the brand human and is shareable.”

Ganapathy Balagopalan, Head of Strategic Planning, Ogilvy, the agency that handles Pidilite and 5Star among others, maintains that on lingo, the rule is simple: speaking their lingo is not the same as using their slang. Language takes many forms, among which are targeted digital campaigns or a different brand experience.

Speaking directly to their lifestyles, points out Goupal, is one approach his company has taken. The *Holi* campaign for Parachute Advanced Gold had a playful musical track created with young influencers to resonate with Gen Z.

For Set Wet, it was decided to collaborate with leading gaming creators to drive awareness and consideration for its styling range, to target young males in their native environment. “Young

brands like Set Wet and Livon are kept fresh, dynamic and aligned with Gen Z’s evolving mindset,” adds Goupal.

LOOKING AHEAD

HUL’s Nair, during the earnings call, also highlighted rural transformation as an exciting prospect. Within this, she highlighted “road infrastructure, better electrification, tap water in every home or indeed digital” as truly transforming how consumers become aware of new propositions, new brands and new products. “Therefore, for HUL, it is very critical that we span across this price-product benefit pyramid, transforming our core brands in line with these consumers.”

Goupal maintains that the initiatives taken by Marico go beyond any conventional approach. “It must be understood that they (Gen Z) influence cultural trends, drive rapid adoption of new platforms and expect brands to engage meaningfully across social, gaming and influencer ecosystems,” he says.

The onus on marketers is evident. “They have to adjust to a new reality and must adapt. Else, they run the risk of irrelevance,” maintains Jaiswal. According to him, the 4 Ps (product, price, place and promotion) will remain, though AI and new technology will change the process of decision making. In the past, the emotional route was often the clincher and ensured brand loyalty over time. “Gen Z is open to multiple choices and looks closely at the pros and cons. The cognitive route is one that they easily take,” he says.

In the new and free-spirited India, the strength of Gen Z has to be one of the most remarkable stories. There is clearly a long tail to this most interesting story. **BT**

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